

SPACE COMBAT

Six-minute engagements • range bands • gunnery • defence

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01 / MANOEUVRE

Pilot assigns Thrust to range changes and manoeuvres.

START THE BATTLE

Initiative: 2D + pilot's Pilot skill + ship Thrust.

Naval tactics: Add the commander's Tactics (naval) Effect to Initiative at battle start.

Roll once per ship. Surprise prevents actions in round one.

RANGE & MOVEMENT

Band	Separation	T
Adjacent	≤ 1 km	1
Close	1-10 km	1
Short	11-1,250 km	2
Medium	1,251-10,000 km	5
Long	10,001-25,000 km	10
Very Long	25,001-50,000 km	25
Distant	> 50,000 km	50

T = Thrust cost to move from that band to the next closer or farther band. Save progress across rounds.

Closing ships add movement Thrust; pursuit uses the difference. Reserve unused Thrust for manoeuvres or evasion.

At Close or Adjacent: switch immediately to six-second dogfighting rounds (p. 2).

02 / ATTACK

Weapons fire in Initiative order; targets may react.

ATTACK ROLL / 8+ REQUIRED

2D + Gunner specialty + DEX DM + modifiers

Bonus	Penalty
Short range +1	Long range -2
Beam laser +4	Very Long -4
Pulse laser +2	Distant -6
Each full 1,000t +1	Pilot firing turret -2
Target size max +6	

Pilot may fire fixed mounts or one turret (-2). Observe each weapon's maximum range.

DAMAGE / CRITICAL HITS

Weapon damage + attack Effect - Armour = Hull lost

Critical: Effect 6+ AND damage penetrates Armour. Severity = Effect - 5; roll 2D for location.

Sustained: Each 10% of starting Hull lost also inflicts a Severity 1 critical.

Hull 0 = wreck. Extra critical damage ignores Armour.

MULTI-WEAPON TURRETS

Same-type lasers: one roll, +1/damage die per extra gun. Mixed types: one type/round. Missiles: salvos.

03 / ACTIONS

Each participating crew member takes one duty action.

REACTIONS / DEFENCE

Evasive Action (pilot): Spend 1 unspent Thrust per incoming attack; that attack takes a penalty equal to pilot skill.

Disperse Sand (gunner): Gunner (turret) 8+ against a laser; success grants Armour +1D + check Effect for that attack. Use 1 canister.

Point Defence (gunner): Turret laser, Gunner (turret) 8+ as a missile salvo strikes; remove missiles equal to check Effect. One try/round.

Point-defence turret cannot attack that round. Two/three lasers give +1/+2 to its check.

Called shot: At Short or closer, direct fire only; attack -2. On a critical, choose its location.

GROUND / SPACECRAFT SCALE

Weapon → target	Hit DM	Damage
Ground → spacecraft	+2	+10
Spacecraft → ground	-2	×10

Scale damage after Effect and other damage modifiers. Ship weapons striking ground targets gain Blast 10.

ASSIGN CREW DUTIES

One pilot and one captain; multiple engineers, sensor operators, gunners and marines. Changing duty uses the Actions Step.

TACTICAL OPERATIONS

Missile salvos • crew duties • dogfights • boarding

MISSILE FLIGHT

Launch range	Impact
Medium and closer	Immediate
Long	After 1 round
Very Long	After 4 rounds
Distant	After 10 rounds

Salvo: one ship, one target, one round. At Adjacent/Close, no Smart. Fuel runs out after 10 rounds.

TRACK / COUNTER A SALVO

Detect launch: Electronics (sensors) 6+; 8+ if firing ship unseen. +1 per full 10 missiles (max +6).

Later detection: 8+ at start of each round while still undetected.

Electronic Warfare: In Actions Step, Electronics (sensors) 10+; remove Effect missiles. One attempt per salvo per round.

Point Defence reacts at impact (see p. 1). Evasion affects the salvo attack roll.

IMPACT / DAMAGE

2D + 1 per remaining missile + other modifiers vs 8+

No launching Gunner skill or range DM. Distant launch: -2. Apply Smart, Evasive Action and other relevant DMs.

(One missile damage - Armour) × capped Effect

No Effect added to base damage. Cap Effect at number of surviving missiles.

ACTIONS STEP / ONE PER CREW

Captain - improve Initiative: Leadership check Effect, even negative, applies next round only.

Engineer - repair: Engineer 8+ with DM -critical Severity; +1 cumulative per round on same hit. Temporary fix lasts 1D hours.

Engineer - overload: M-drive 10+ gives +1 Thrust next round; power 10+ gives +10% current Power next round.

Each later overload attempt: cumulative -2. Failure with Effect -6 or less inflicts Severity 1 critical on the system.

MORE DUTY ACTIONS

Sensors - lock: Electronics (sensors) 8+ grants the ship +2 to attacks on that target until lock is broken.

Sensors - EW: Opposed Electronics (comms) to jam communications or (sensors) to break a sensor lock.

Gunner - reload: Turret cannot attack this round. Any Traveller with Gunner can reload.

Anyone - reassign: Use this action; new duty begins next round.

Engineer may also offline systems or prepare a jump; combat jump checks become one difficulty higher (1D minutes).

PILOT / MANOEUVRE STEP

Spend 1 Thrust per manoeuvre: aid gunners (Pilot task chain), dock (Pilot check; opposed with -2 if resisted), or reserve Thrust for evasion.

DOGFIGHT / ≤ 10 KM

Switch to 6-second rounds: Use normal combat order. At round start, opposed Pilot checks; dedicated Thrust adds +1 per point.

Size penalty: 50+ tons -1; 100+ tons -2; each further full 100 tons -1. Each extra enemy after first: -1.

Winner: +2 to attacks, loser -2; winner controls fixed-weapon firing arcs. Draw: neither fires fixed mounts.

Continuing winner adds prior Pilot-check margin next round. To escape: greater Thrust, enemy consent, or win the dogfight.

BOARDING / ADJACENT

Board during Actions Step. After 2D rounds, compare both sides' 2D + bonuses; margin = attacker - defender.

Margin	Outcome
≤ -7 / -6 to -4	Crushed / repelled
-3 to -1	Continue; defender +2
0 / +1 to +3	Continue; none / attacker +2
+4 to +6	Success; control in 2D rounds
≥ +7	Immediate control

Bonuses: armour +1, weapons +1, skills/tactics +2, numbers +1 (vastly +3). Defender without marines takes -2.

CRITICAL LOCATION / 2D

2 Sensors • 3 Power • 4 Fuel • 5 Weapon • 6 Armour • 7 Hull • 8 M-drive • 9 Cargo • 10 J-drive • 11 Crew • 12 Bridge

Reroll inapplicable locations. For full Severity effects, see rulebook p. 170.